

Holdings Covered Thousands Of Acres

(Continued From Page 2)

day Men were miserable, battleworn and full of disgust at being routed by the Indians. The morning brought snow that made traveling tough. They were headed for John Chisum's Ranch which was the nearest refuge, though it was almost a hundred miles down the Hondo River.

The following day they had a bit of luck. They came upon a band of eight Tonk Indians who had gathered 250 horses from the scene of the battle. The soldiers gave the Tonks two horses each and took the rest for themselves and the deborshed cattlemen.

"My grandfather and his friends and soldiers were 10 days getting to the Chisum Ranch. They were made welcome and Chisum sent out to the camp 1,500 pounds of flour and furnished the men with all the beef they could eat. Lt. Giddian and the seriously wounded men were taken to the Chisum Ranch house, and given the best care that was available. After hot bread, broiled beef and hot coffee, the defeated group began to perk up. They "licked their wounds" and were grateful they were alive.

"The second day at the Ranch Lt. Giddian sent for my grandfather and had him read a letter he had been carrying in his pocket. It was from his wife. The young officer dictated a letter to his wife to my father, and also had him write his will. My grandfather, Isaac Gregory and I. D. Ferguson were witnesses. The lieutenant lapsed into a coma a short time after this and died. He is buried on the Hondo where a wooden cross still marks the grave. The soldiers and cattlemen stayed at the Chisum Ranch until they were able to go their separate ways. None of the participants in this raid were ever able to forget the defeat they suffered at the hands of the Kickapoo Indians."

CAME HERE IN 1925

James Waide was made captain of Company I, Cook County Minute Men. He was a rugged pioneer, a loyal friend, a staunch citizen. He died in 1897. All of his sons and daughters settled near the Old Chisum Trail, in what is known as "The Waide Settlement" which extended from Denton County into Wise and Cook Counties. The Waide holdings covered many thousands of acres. Many descendants of this pioneer family still own and live on farms and ranches in this settlement.

Webster Waide finished Greenwood High School



FOLLOWS TRADITION — Webster Waide was born on the Chisum Trail. His grandfather, father and uncles were all cattlemen. So, when he retired from education, he and his wife bought a ranch in northern New Mexico.

In Wise County, and then attended the Southwestern University and North Texas College.

"I started my teaching career at Leo, Texas," Waide explained. "I came to El Paso in 1925 and my first job with the schools here was as truant officer. There were two of us. When we had a boy high school absentee we knew where to find him during the early spring or fall months, unless he was sick in bed. He would be with some of his friends near the outlet of the old power plant on the Rio Grande in the Upper Valley. We hated to make a boy don his clothes and take him back to the four walls of his school room." He chuckled softly. "But that was our job. Sometimes there would be a half a dozen boys on the river, sometimes only one."

In 1926 Mr. Waide began doing part time census work with the schools, and four years later he was devoting all his time to this tremendous job. All school age children, 6 to 17, have to be counted each year. Waide remembers that when he began his census work a scholastic was worth \$14, now each is worth \$72.70 in state money.

Waide worked out a card filing system which is followed today. The schools have a complete record of every child from his first day of school until graduation, or is proved a permanent "dropout."

Children crossing the international border to attend school in El Paso carry cards which gives the school a complete record of their daily crossing. The first records, dating back to 1902 were not complete.

"Over the years since I set up my card filing system," Waide commented, "we have been able to help many El Pasoans establish not only their nationality, but their age, and schooling. We frequently receive letters thanking us for this invaluable help we give people in obtaining positions, passports etc."

So Webster Waide, who as a boy wanted to be a cattleman and tally cows, spent the greater part of his life "tallying children" in the El Paso Schools.

Mrs. Waide was also a teacher and retired from the El Paso Schools after 28 years of service. They spend their springs, summers and falls at the ranch, and the winter months find them at their home in El Paso at 2621 Pershing.



Indian Raids

- 1865
Jan 5. x Raided down clear creek
by Sna. to Hainesville hills
saw July Patrick & others
- 1864
Apr 27. x Killed Sol. Somers & family
Jeff Chisum & Julia killed
Warden Black Station
- 1863
Oct 23. x Killed Spide, mares, near
Jenny McCon. & killed 6 head
of Gals horses in Cook Co.
- 1862
Oct 28. x Killed some 5 head horses
for Wade near Willons in
Cook Co.
- 1861
Oct 30. x Killed. Coomes and horse
Fortcherry on Clear
Creek Denton Co.

INDIAN RAIDS — A record was kept of Indian raids in 1862 listing the location and the number of men and animals killed.

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